

gEDA: A Complete Set Of Tools For Electronics Design

When there was no free electronic design software available for Linux and Unix users, gEDA, or GPL-Electronics Design Automation, project took the initiative to cater to the needs of PCB designers. Today, gEDA is one of the most popular collections of open source software tools for electronics circuit design, licensed under GPL. Circuit designers get access to a complete set of tools that are generally required by them.

The tools are useful for operations like schematic design and capture, netlisting, PCB layout creation, circuit simulation, prototype generation, bill of material generation and production, among others. Since gEDA software collection was primarily aimed towards Linux and Unix platforms, all tools run seamlessly on these operating systems. Most tools are also compatible with Mac OS X. Windows users, too, get some tools that are compatible with the platform.

Components of gEDA

gEDA suite comprises the following tools.

gEDA/gaf. gaf (short for gscheme and friends) is the original gEDA project tool created by the team. It is a subset of various important tools that are maintained by the core gEDA development team. Tools in the subset are described below.

gschem is the main circuit schematic capture program of gEDA tool. It has a compact user interface (UI) with many functionalities. Schematics can be drawn on the workspace. Various quick access buttons on the UI enable easy usage of the tool. All components and connections drawn are captured by the tool. gEDA suite

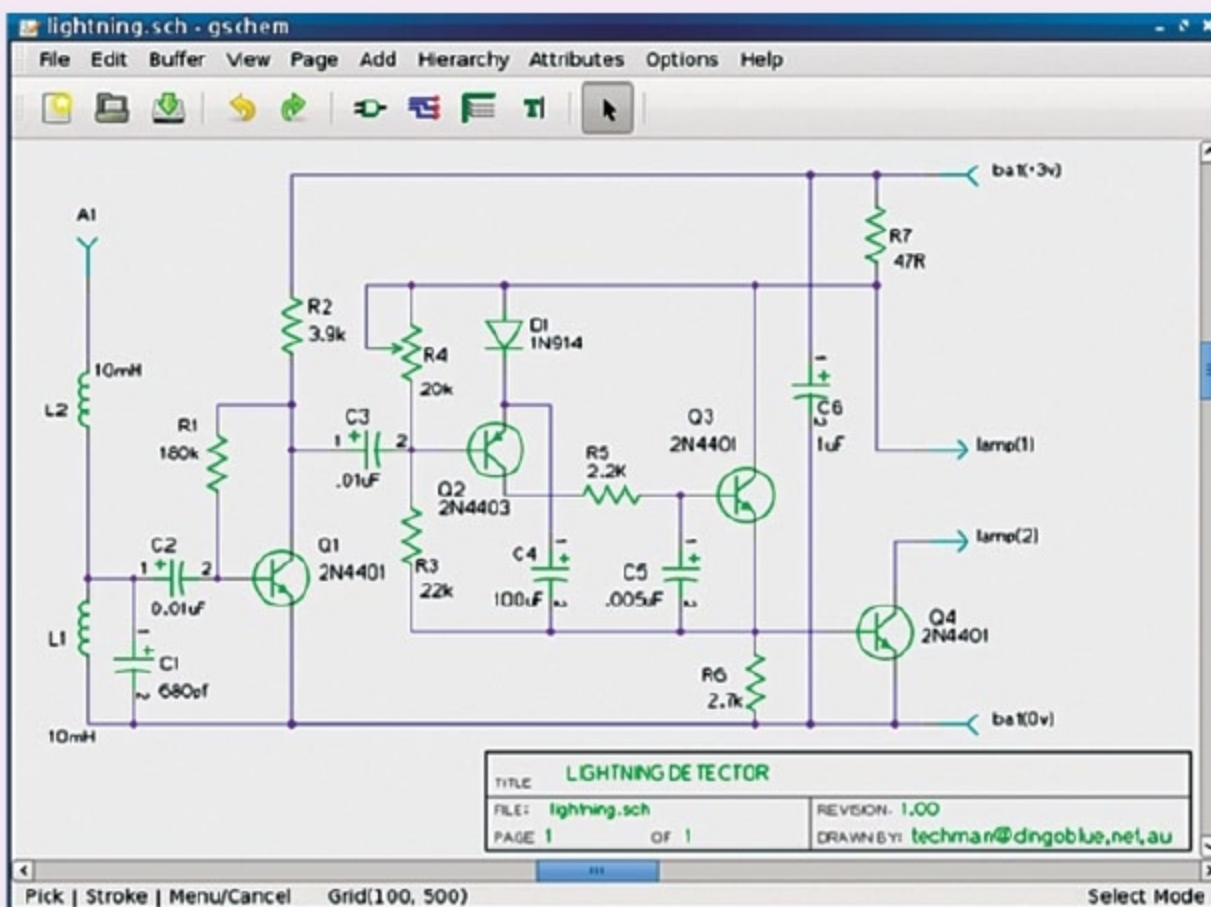


Fig. 1: A schematic on gschem tool

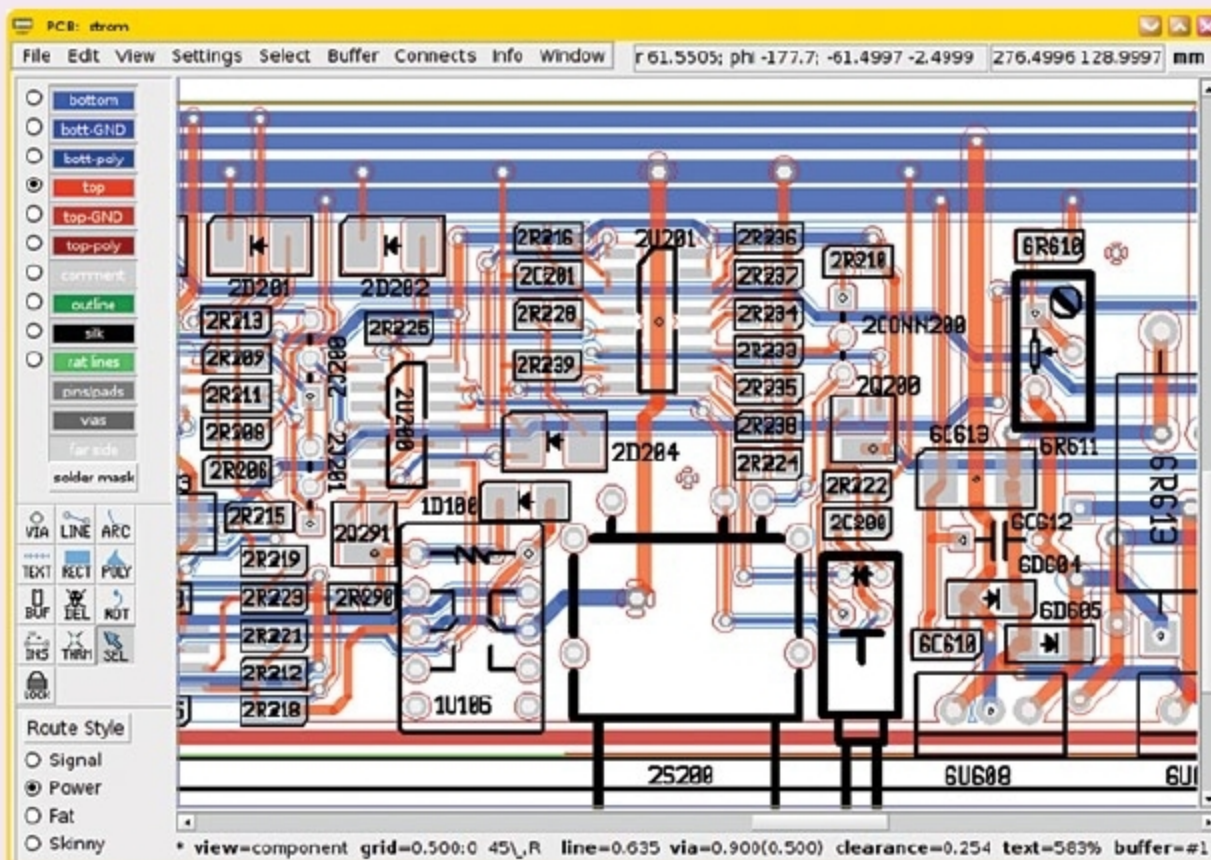


Fig. 2: Creating a layout on PCB

stores the netlists of the schematics for further operations.

gnetlist is the suite's program to

generate netlists of the various components and connections used in the schematic creation tool. It supports